

Los Gigantes Cliffs

A line of breathtakingly high cliffs on the western coast of Tenerife in the Canary Islands

Los Gigantes, or “the Giants,” rise up to 2,620 ft (800 m) in places and are made of the igneous rock basalt. The cliffs continue under the sea to the seabed some 100 ft (30 m) deep, which harbors a rich variety of marine life.

Tenerife is built from three volcanoes that coalesced about 3 million years ago into a larger volcano. The Los Gigantes Cliffs are the result of the erosion of a huge mass of solidified lava.

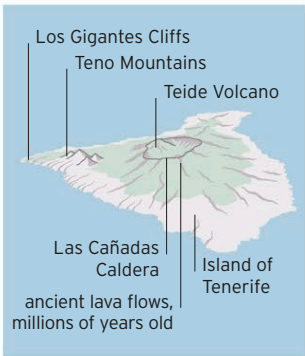
▷ **GEMS IN THE CLIFFS**

Crystals of the olive-green mineral peridot are occasionally found in rocks and on beaches around Tenerife.



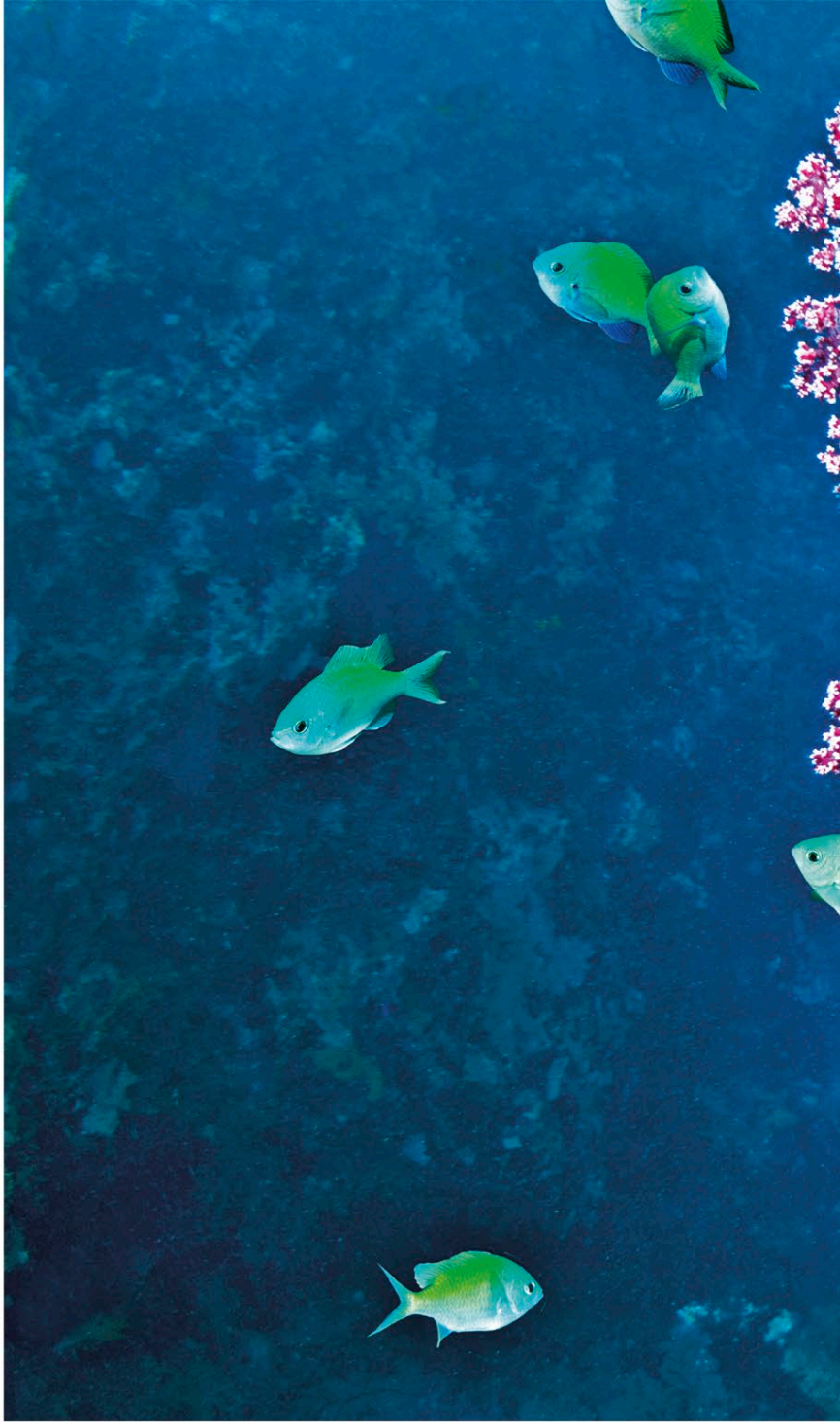
LOCATION OF LOS GIGANTES

The Los Gigantes Cliffs are located where multiple layers of basalt—solidified lava erupted by one of Tenerife’s original volcanoes—have been eroded away by the sea. The mass of basalt makes up an area in the western part of Tenerife called the Teno Mountains.



△ **THE END OF THE WORLD**

In classical times, 3,000 years ago, mariners thought these cliffs marked the end of the dry world, beyond which there was only ocean.



ZONES OF A FRINGING CORAL REEF

A fringing reef has several zones. Facing the sea, the fore-reef is populated by different corals at different depths. At its top is the reef crest, which takes the brunt of wave action. On the shoreward side is the inner reef (or reef flat), which may become partly exposed at low tide.

